

ILLUSTRATIONS BY **TANMOY CHAKRABORTY**

from India recommended by CII. The WEF also mostly respected the recommendations of CII as speakers at Davos. It also recognised the India reception organised by CII, a highlight of the week, plus Indian fashion shows, musical performances to project Indian culture, which presented the country as more than just a business destination. CII also deputed a staff member to WEF to work with their team year after year.

This partnership had a central figure in WEF, Colette Mathur, who was responsible for India. This relationship, the mutual trust and respect, enabled India to steadily achieve its objectives. The Government of India recognised her role, bestowing her with a Padma Award.

Challenges: The WEF however, under Klaus Schwab, the Chairman, had its own priorities.

First, the US. Second, Europe.

And only third was Asia. In Asia, China was a priority, naturally, as it galloped into the centre of the economic world.

But India persisted and edged in to make its presence felt in Davos, climaxing with the “India Everywhere” Programme at Davos 2006 under the leadership of Nandan Nilekani. The programme gave India a dominant presence that year. India truly “stormed” Davos.